

TEXT OF THE OPENING REMARKS BY
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LIFE PATRON, PHARMACEUTICAL ASSOCIATION OF NIGERIAN
STUDENTS (PANS), AHMADU BELLO UNIVERSITY (ABU)
CHAPTER

ON THE OCCASION OF THE 2026 PHARMACY WEEK OF THE
PHARMACEUTICAL ASSOCIATION OF NIGERIAN STUDENTS
(PANS), ABU CHAPTER, AND THE 3RD LECTURE IN THE SERIES IN
HONOUR OF PROFESSOR A. T. MORA, HELD AT THE FACULTY
OF PHARMACEUTICAL SCIENCES, AHMADU BELLO
UNIVERSITY, ZARIA, ON SATURDAY, 8TH AUGUST, 2026

Protocol.

It gives me great pleasure to deliver these Opening Remarks in my capacity as the Chairman of the 2026 Pharmacy Week of the Pharmaceutical Association of Nigerian Students (PANS), Ahmadu Bello University (ABU) Chapter, as well as the 3rd Lecture in the Series held in my honour.

At the outset, I warmly congratulate the Mukhtar Danjuma Aliyu-led Executive Committee of PANS (ABU Chapter) for successfully organising this year's Pharmacy Week and for sustaining the tradition of the Annual Lecture Series. Their commitment, dedication, and hard work are highly commendable.

The combination of the 2026 Pharmacy Week and the 3rd Lecture in the Series in my honour is indeed a unique and remarkable event in the history of this Faculty. When viewed alongside the successful hosting of the 12th Annual Late Pharm. Dahiru Suleiman Wali, FPSN Lecture on 23rd July, 2026, it becomes evident that this PANS Executive Committee, together with the Dean and staff of the Faculty, has hosted, or is hosting, more major public pharmacy-related events within a single year than many can recall in recent times. This is truly worthy of commendation.

For me personally, this occasion evokes fond memories. Exactly fifty years ago, in 1976, I served as the Public Relations Officer (PRO) of PANS (ABU Chapter)

and was also the Secretary of the Organising Committee of the very first Pharmacy Week ever held by the Association in Ahmadu Bello University.

Fifty years is a significant milestone. Over these five decades, Pharmacy education and training, as well as professional practice in Nigeria, have witnessed tremendous growth and transformation. It is gratifying to observe the remarkable progress that has been made and to see our profession assuming an increasingly important role in healthcare delivery and national development.

At this juncture, I wish to place on record my profound appreciation to Professor Mohammed Garba Magaji for his unwavering support for the progress and development of PANS (ABU Chapter), the ABU Pharmacy Alumni Association (ABUPAA), and indeed my humble self in my capacity as a Part-Time Lecturer in the Department of Clinical Pharmacy and Pharmacy Practice over the past forty years.

I also wish to express my sincere gratitude to the Dean of the Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences for his exemplary leadership, encouragement, and consistent support for initiatives that promote academic excellence and professional development. We shall never take the support of the Dean and, by extension, that of the University Administration for granted. We remain deeply grateful.

I cannot conclude these Opening Remarks without commending the Organising Committee for selecting a timely and highly relevant theme for this year's Pharmacy Week, focusing on the changing landscape of the pharmacy profession. It is an excellent choice that reflects the evolving roles, responsibilities, and opportunities available to pharmacists in contemporary healthcare. I have no doubt that the distinguished symposium speakers will do full justice to this important subject.

I am equally delighted that Professor O. O. Kunle graciously accepted our invitation to deliver the 3rd Lecture in the Series in my honour. Your acceptance is deeply appreciated, and we eagerly look forward to benefiting from your wealth of knowledge and experience.

It is noteworthy that the inaugural lecture in this series was delivered in August 2024 by Pharm. Ibrahim Babashehu Ahmed, the Registrar and Chief Executive Officer of the Pharmacy Council of Nigeria (PCN), here in this Faculty. The second lecture, held in 2025, was delivered by Pharm. Aliyu Jibrin, *FPSN*, Interim National Chairman of the ABU Pharmacy Alumni Association

(ABUPAA). We are confident that today's lecture will further enrich this growing intellectual tradition.

Distinguished ladies and gentlemen, I have every confidence that this morning's programme will be intellectually stimulating, professionally enriching, and memorable for all participants.

On this note, it is my singular honour and privilege to formally declare the 2026 Pharmacy Week of the Pharmaceutical Association of Nigerian Students (PANS), Ahmadu Bello University (ABU) Chapter, and the 3rd Lecture in the Series in Honour of Professor A. T. Mora officially open.

Thank you very much for your kind attention.

Professor Ahmed Tijjani Mora,

PhD, OON, FPCPharm, FPSN, FICEN, FIHMN, FNIM, mni

K'ayayen Sarkin Musulmi, Wakilin Maganin Zazzau, Iyan Piriga

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